Gerald Croft

Portrayed from the beginning of the play as an upper- class gentleman who occupies a position of privilege in society and in the Birling's home. Mr Birling is clearly intent on impressing Gerald Croft from the beginning of the play in order to win his favour and to be finally connected to his family through the engagement and marriage to Sheila. He represents the stubbornness of the aristocracy and is clearly a sought -after man due to the financial stability his alliance with the Birling's will bring. He is described **"an attractive chap about thirty, rather too manly to be a dandy but very much the easy well-bred man-about-town."**
Priestley uses Gerald to highlight the power and status that the upper classes possess in society and the hypocrisy and selfishness they display. Gerald provides a strong contrast to Eric, Mr Birling's natural son and Priestley uses Gerald to show the tensions between Eric and his father.
Through Gerald, Priestley shows that it was common for the upper classes to behave arrogantly towards the working and lower classes and also to accept the condescending behaviour that other upper and middle classes towards them.

Key Quotes

"You couldn't have done anything else" (sacking Eva Smith)

"After all, y'know, we're respectable citizens and not criminals"

(about Sheila): "She's obviously had about as much as she can stand"

"Why should you [stay]? It's bound to be unpleasant and disturbing"

"It's a favourite haunt of women of the town"
'[Daisy] gave me a glance that was nothing less than a cry for help"

"Everything's all right now Sheila. What about this ring?"

"That man wasn't a police officer…I'm almost certain"

"But how do you know it's the same girl? ...
We've no proof it was the same photograph and therefore no proof it was the same girl"

Themes

Social Class

Power

Exploitation

Class Division

Hypocrisy

How does Priestley present Gerald Croft in An Inspector Calls?

You must include:

AO1 *(Your understanding and interpretation of Gerald in relation to the other* ***characters and the themes and quotations)***
AO2 *(Name and Explain the* ***Language devices and stage directions*** *that portray ideas about Gerald)*
AO3 *(****Context*** *– Ideas about the historical, political and social background)*

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